

C722

Project Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A software rollout has four activities. A (3 days) starts the project. B (5 days) and C (7 days) both follow A and can run at the same time. D (2 days) follows both B and C. Activity B is staffed by the firm's two most senior engineers. What is the shortest possible project duration?

- A. 10 days
- B. 12 days
- C. 7 days
- D. 17 days

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In a project where path A-C-D takes 12 days and path A-B-D takes 10 days, how much can activity B slip without delaying the project?

- A. 12 days
- B. 0 days
- C. 5 days
- D. 2 days

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Halfway through building a customer portal, the sponsor, who founded the company, asks for two new features. The budget and launch date are both locked by contract. What is the best response from the project manager?

- A. Scope can never change once the plan is approved.
- B. Explain the trade-off: adding scope needs more time or money, or other scope must be cut, or quality will suffer.
- C. Add the features; a skilled team can absorb them with no impact.
- D. Agree, because the sponsor is the founder.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A clinic network's new patient portal has a total budget of \$200,000 and the team works in two-week agile sprints. At the end of month four, planned value is \$100,000, earned value is \$80,000 and actual cost is \$90,000. What is the cost performance?

- A. CPI 0.89: over budget.
- B. SPI 0.80: behind schedule.
- C. CPI 1.13: under budget.
- D. CPI 0.90: over budget.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A project has an SPI of 0.9 and planned value to date of \$50,000. What is its earned value?

- A. -\$5,000
- B. \$55,556
- C. \$50,000
- D. \$45,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A project manager who holds a PMP certification was told in a hallway conversation to lead a data center move. Department heads now refuse to lend her staff, saying they have seen no approval. Which document is missing?

- A. The lessons-learned report
- B. The work breakdown structure
- C. The project charter
- D. The project schedule

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

At an engineering firm with offices in three states, staff are assigned full-time to a single project, report directly to the project manager, and have no home department to return to when the project ends. The project manager controls the budget. Which structure is this?

- A. Projectized
- B. Functional
- C. Matrix
- D. Strong matrix, because multiple offices require shared reporting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In which organizational structure does a project manager usually have the least authority over people and budget?

- A. Strong matrix
- B. PM authority is the same in every structure.
- C. Projectized
- D. Functional

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A home builder that has completed 40 homes in the area buys a \$12,000 insurance policy covering storm damage during construction. Which risk response is this?

- A. Mitigate
- B. Avoid
- C. Transfer
- D. Accept, because \$12,000 is small compared to the budget.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team worries that a new, untested database may fail. Which action is an avoidance response?

- A. Switch to a proven database the team already uses.
- B. Add extra load testing before launch.
- C. Buy a vendor warranty that pays for failures.
- D. Set aside a contingency reserve in case it fails.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A client department head emails a developer directly asking for one extra report in the new billing system. The developer, the team's fastest coder, says it will take only a day and starts on it. What should the project manager do?

- A.** Refuse every change once the baseline is set.
- B.** Route the request through change control to assess impact and get approval.
- C.** Let it go, since one day is small.
- D.** It is fine because the developer is fast.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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12.

Three weeks into a project, a team of seven that spans two time zones is arguing about who owns which tasks and openly questioning the project manager's decisions. Which stage of team development is this?

- A.** Performing, because conflict shows they are engaged.
- B.** Forming
- C.** Storming
- D.** Norming

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A software rollout has four activities. A (3 days) starts the project. B (5 days) and C (7 days) both follow A and can run at the same time. D (2 days) follows both B and C. ~~Activity B is staffed by the firm's two most senior engineers.~~ What is the shortest possible project duration?

Target word: project duration **Decides:** Longest path A-C-D = 3 + 7 + 2.

A	Inverted operation	Uses the shortest path; the project cannot finish before its longest path.
B	Correct	A-C-D = 12 is longer than A-B-D = 10, so it is the critical path.
C	Wrong stem number	The longest single activity, not the longest path.
D	Adjacent category	Adds every activity as if B and C could not run in parallel.

2. Answer D Concept 1 • transfer

In a project where path A-C-D takes 12 days and path A-B-D takes 10 days, how much can activity B slip without delaying the project?

Target word: slack on a noncritical activity **Decides:** Slack = critical path length – B's path length.

A	Dropped element	The project duration; drops the subtraction of B's path.
B	Confusion set	Zero slack applies to critical activities; B is not on the critical path.
C	Wrong stem number	B's duration, not its slack.
D	Correct	12 – 10 = 2 days of slack on the A-B-D path.

3. Answer B Concept 2

Halfway through building a customer portal, the sponsor, ~~who founded the company,~~ asks for two new features. The budget and launch date are both locked by contract. What is the best response from the project manager?

Target word: effect of added scope under fixed time and cost **Decides:** Scope grows while time and cost are fixed.

A	Absolute language	Scope can change through change control, with trade-offs.
B	Correct	The triple constraint links scope, time and cost.
C	Dropped element	Drops the link between scope and time and cost.
D	Camouflage	The sponsor's role does not remove the constraint.

4. Answer A Concept 3

A clinic network's new patient portal has a total budget of \$200,000 and the team works in two-week agile sprints. At the end of month four, planned value is \$100,000, earned value is \$80,000 and actual cost is \$90,000. What is the cost performance?

Target word: cost performance **Decides:** $CPI = EV / AC = 80,000 / 90,000$.

A	Correct	$80,000 / 90,000 \approx 0.89$; less than \$1 of value per \$1 spent.
B	Confusion set	True, but that is schedule performance, not cost.
C	Inverted operation	$90,000 / 80,000$ flips the ratio.
D	Wrong stem number	$90,000 / 100,000$ uses planned value instead of earned value.

5. Answer D Concept 3 • transfer

A project has an SPI of 0.9 and planned value to date of \$50,000. What is its earned value?

Target word: solve for EV **Decides:** $EV = SPI \times PV$.

A	Adjacent category	That is the schedule variance, not EV.
B	Inverted operation	$\$50,000 / 0.9$ divides instead of multiplies.
C	Wrong stem number	Planned value, not earned value.
D	Correct	$0.9 \times \$50,000 = \$45,000$.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A project manager who holds a PMP certification was told in a hallway conversation to lead a data center move. Department heads now refuse to lend her staff, saying they have seen no approval. Which document is missing?

Target word: document that authorizes the project and PM **Decides:** No formal authorization exists.

A	Inverted operation	A closing document, the opposite end of the life cycle.
B	Adjacent category	The WBS defines scope during planning; it grants no authority.
C	Correct	The charter authorizes the project and the PM's use of resources.
D	Confusion set	A planning output, not authorization.

7. Answer A Concept 5

At an engineering firm with offices in three states, staff are assigned full-time to a single project, report directly to the project manager, and have no home department to return to when the project ends. The project manager controls the budget. Which structure is this?

Target word: organizational structure **Decides:** Full-time team reports to the PM, who controls the budget.

A	Correct	Dedicated teams report to a PM with full authority.
B	Inverted operation	The opposite: functional managers hold authority and PMs have little.
C	Adjacent category	In a matrix, staff also report to a functional manager.
D	Camouflage	Office count does not decide reporting lines.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

In which organizational structure does a project manager usually have the least authority over people and budget?

Target word: structure with least PM authority **Decides:** Department heads control resources in a functional structure.

A	Adjacent category	Tilts authority toward the PM.
B	Absolute language	Authority varies sharply by structure.
C	Inverted operation	Gives the PM the most authority.
D	Correct	Functional managers hold the resources; PMs coordinate.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A home builder ~~that has completed 40 homes in the area~~ buys a \$12,000 insurance policy covering storm damage during construction. Which risk response is this?

Target word: risk response type **Decides:** Financial impact is shifted to a third party.

A	Adjacent category	Mitigation reduces probability or impact; insurance does not reduce the chance of storms.
B	Confusion set	Avoidance changes the plan to remove the threat; building continues.
C	Correct	Insurance moves the financial impact to the insurer.
D	Camouflage	The premium's size does not change the response type.

10. Answer A Concept 6 • transfer

A team worries that a new, untested database may fail. Which action is an avoidance response?

Target word: pick the action, working from the strategy name **Decides:** Avoidance removes the threat by changing the plan.

A	Correct	Changing the plan eliminates the threat.
B	Confusion set	That is mitigation; the risk remains, only smaller.
C	Adjacent category	That is transfer.
D	Inverted operation	That is active acceptance, the opposite of removing the threat.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A client department head emails a developer directly asking for one extra report in the new billing system. The developer, ~~the team's fastest coder~~, says it will take only a day and starts on it. What should the project manager do?

Target word: handling an informal scope request **Decides:** A scope change bypassed change control.

A	Absolute language	Changes are allowed, but through a formal process.
B	Correct	Formal change control prevents scope creep.
C	Dropped element	Drops impact analysis; small additions add up to scope creep.
D	Camouflage	Speed does not replace approval.

12. Answer C Concept 8

Three weeks into a project, a team of seven that spans two time zones is arguing about who owns which tasks and openly questioning the project manager's decisions. Which stage of team development is this?

Target word: team stage **Decides:** Conflict over roles and authority.

A	Confusion set	Performing teams work smoothly; open role conflict is earlier.
B	Adjacent category	Forming is polite and uncertain, before conflict appears.
C	Correct	Conflict over roles and leadership marks storming.
D	Inverted operation	Norming comes after conflict is resolved.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Critical path	The critical path is the longest path through the network; it sets the shortest possible project duration, and its activities have zero slack.	Picking the shortest path, or adding up every activity.	A network with parallel paths and a question about duration or delay.
2	The triple constraint	Scope, time and cost are linked; changing one forces a change in another or puts quality at risk.	Thinking scope can grow while budget and deadline stay fixed at no cost.	A mid-project request with a locked budget or date.
3	Earned value indexes	$CPI = EV / AC$ (cost); $SPI = EV / PV$ (schedule); below 1.0 is bad.	Flipping the ratio or using PV for cost performance.	PV, EV and AC in one stem.
4	The project charter	The charter formally authorizes the project in initiation and gives the project manager authority to use resources.	Confusing it with planning documents like the WBS or schedule.	A project manager with no formal authority or sponsor sign-off.
5	Organizational structure and PM authority	Functional = low PM authority; matrix = shared; projectized = high, with a dedicated team that reports to the PM.	Mixing up which structure gives the PM the most control.	Who team members report to and who controls the budget.
6	Risk response strategies	Avoid = remove the threat by changing the plan; transfer = shift impact to a third party; mitigate = reduce probability or impact; accept = acknowledge and reserve.	Calling insurance mitigation.	Insurance, contracts, plan changes, or extra testing.
7	Change control	Every scope change goes through formal change control: impact analysis, then approval, before work starts.	Letting small requests slip in informally (scope creep).	A stakeholder asks a team member directly for an extra feature.
8	Team development stages	Forming, storming, norming, performing (then adjourning); conflict over roles and methods marks storming.	Treating conflict as a sign of failure or of high performance.	A new team arguing about roles, goals or the leader's decisions.

Course scope (public description): Project Management prepares you to manage projects from start to finish within any organization structure. The course represents a view into different project-management methods and delves into topics such as project profiling and phases, constraints, building the project team, scheduling, and risk. You will be able to grasp the full scope of projects you may work with on in the future, and apply proper management approaches to complete a project. The course features practice in each of the project phases as you learn how to strategically apply project-management tools and techniques to help organizations achieve their goals.